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UNESCO

BACKGROUND GUIDE

TRITONMUN XXXI – APRIL 12TH, 2026

MODEL UNITED NATIONS AT UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

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HEAD CHAIR LETTER

Greetings delegates!

I am delighted to be your UNESCO head chair for TritonMUN XXXI! My name is Shannon M.M. Clarke, and I'm a first-year student majoring in education at Muir College. This topic was inspired by one of my first college courses, where we explored the connection between language and culture, and specifically learned a lot about the nuances and backgrounds of endangered and dying languages. Every country on Earth has its own unique linguistic history, something that would be very interesting and thorough for delegates to explore.

About me, I'm from Los Angeles, specifically the San Fernando Valley (proud valley girl), and my main interests are marked by what my friends are most knowledgeable about against their wills due to my consistent yapping, such as: the Dodgers (really anything MLB related), baking/cooking, and matcha. This is my fourth year in MUN, as I began in my sophomore year of high school and have loved it ever since. Here at UCSD, if I'm not begging my friends to get Yogurtworld with me (UCSD's froyo shop), I'm probably on my way to Art of Espresso, the best matcha on campus, where the employees know me a little too well for the sake of my Triton Cash (UCSD monopoly money).

I'm very excited to see what you all bring to this committee; the history of language is anything but black and white. As the connection between language and culture is undeniable, I hope each and every one of you indulge in exploring the cultural contexts of linguistic history. In other words, I hope you all enjoy inevitably falling down complex rabbit holes in your pursuit of research. I'm interested to see how delegates will approach the nuances of language preservation, especially in a globalized world where communication has been reevaluated by means of technology, business, and an advancing global interconnectivity.

I'm excited to learn what each and every one of you make of this topic!

Sincerely,

Shannon M.M. Clarke (smclarke@ucsd.edu)

VICE CHAIR LETTER

Hello Delegates!

My name is Kaitlyn Phan and I will be your Vice Chair for UNESCO TritonMUN XXXI! I am currently a 2nd-year student at Eleanor Roosevelt College majoring in Political Science: International Relations. This is my 2nd year with MUN@UCSD, but I have been involved in MUN since middle school! Outside of TMUN, I am also Director General of Sun God MUN, our collegiate conference!

My hometown is Whittier, CA, technically located in LA county, but I feel more spiritually connected to OC. I definitely take advantage of being a Californian girl, as I love snowboarding, surfing, playing basketball, hiking, and eating (yum). When I am not spending time with my friends, I love to watch anime and collect/read manga in my down time! If you catch me after committee, I would be more than happy to talk about all things anime related with you!

Specializing in International Relations means that I have been lucky to take many classes that focus on the interconnectedness of our world and how different countries, cultures, and societies interact with each other today and across history. Communication today has been redefined by globalization, allowing individuals from around the world to share culture, experiences, and languages that we otherwise would not have had access to. However, in the midst of this exchange, languages and cultures get lost amongst each other, resulting in thousands of languages and cultures going extinct. Living in a world where everybody is exposed to different cultures and languages everyday, I hope delegates will be able to resonate with the topic at hand, and I am just as excited to see how delegates work together to preserve the languages and cultures of today!

Sincerely,

Kaitlyn Phan (ktp004@ucsd.edu)

POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

TRITONMUN POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

- Position Papers are due on **April 3rd at 11:59pm.**
 - Requests for extensions must be sent by the advisor to TritonMUN by **March 22nd.**
- Position Papers must be submitted to the **Google Form** linked here:
 - <https://forms.gle/M3aPRormuovAhSEw8>
- Format.
 - Papers should be double-spaced in Times New Roman 12 pt. font and include no pictures.
 - At the top of each paper, include your country/person, name, committee, and topic.
 - Required* Sections: Each of these sections should be clearly labeled
 - Background
 - Past Actions by the Committee (if applicable)
 - Position of your Country/Person
 - Possible Solutions

*Some committees may ask for different formatting or an alternative to a position paper altogether, this will be clearly noted in the background guide for that committee

RULES OF PROCEDURE

Technology Policy

This committee will have a **mixed** technology policy. Technology will only be permitted during unmoderated debate for the purpose of writing working papers and viewing draft resolutions during reading periods. We ask that delegates refrain from using technology during moderated debate.

Sensitivity Statement

In acknowledging this committee is operating on the premise of historical contexts that may contain violent, discriminatory, and prejudicial pasts, we ask that delegates refrain from speaking negatively towards other delegations. We understand that delegates may have personal connections to this topic, however, we would like to remind delegates that those sitting across from you are merely a model representative of that delegation, and therefore, personal attacks of any kind will not be tolerated. On another note, delegates must refer to the TritonMUN DEI policies, and understand that we expect delegates to examine this topic in a respectful and nuanced manner.

DEI AND AI POLICIES

Sensitivity & Harassment Policy:

TritonMUN is committed to fostering a healthy environment for diplomacy and dialogue, and upholding standards of diversity, equity, and inclusion for all delegates. Harassment or disruptive behavior of any kind—whether verbal or non-verbal, in or out of committee—is strictly prohibited. All attendees and staffers should be treated with equal respect, and discrimination on the basis of race, color, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, nationality, ethnicity, or physical/mental disability will not be tolerated. This list is not exhaustive, and should not be treated as such. **Please report any instances of harassment to conference staff, either directly or through the Anonymous Feedback Form.**

In addition, we acknowledge that topics discussed in-committee may be politically sensitive, particularly in Specialized and Crisis Committees. While we understand that delegates may be immersed in the action and setting of their committee, delegates must maintain decorum and refrain from inflammatory language and actions, even when doing so may be historically accurate to one's character, group, or country. When drafting crisis directives, delegates should refrain from pursuing any action that explicitly violates human rights, including—but not limited to—enslavement and genocide. **Please refer to your committee's background guide for specific sensitivity statements and guidelines, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair.**

All attendants should observe these policies during the entirety of the conference, even outside formal debate, including opening/closing ceremonies, "FUNMUN", etc. Please note that violation of these policies may result in consequences such as disqualification from awards and contact towards the delegate's Advisor. At TritonMUN, our goal has always been focused on the delegate's abilities to enjoy and have fun in committee. However, in order to truly enjoy TritonMUN, delegates must feel safe in committee, which starts with respecting one another.

Plagiarism & Generative AI Policy:

TritonMUN recognizes that Model United Nations provides a space for aspiring leaders to showcase their work and abilities, and that all delegates wish to be evaluated in a fair and accurate manner. As such, we expect all delegates to perform with integrity and refrain from plagiarizing the work of their peers. This includes—but is not limited to—claiming the work of another delegate as one's own, including another bloc's unique clause without prior approval from the original writer, and replacing another's work with one's own (i.e. overwriting).

In addition, delegates are strictly prohibited from utilizing generative AI to produce position papers, resolutions, and directives, in part or in their entirety.

Resolution Work Outside of Committee:

TritonMUN wishes that all delegates use their breaks and downtime as intended: to connect, relax, and refresh. While not in committee, delegates are strictly prohibited from working on resolutions and directives. In addition, this means that pre-writing, or preparing resolutions and directives before the start of the conference, is strictly prohibited.

Technology Policy:

Delegates should expect the use of technology to be limited during committee sessions. Instead of having a universal technology policy for TritonMUN, such policies are individualized for each committee and set by their daises. Please refer to each committee's background guide to understand their technology policies, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair. Repercussive actions will be taken at the discretion of the head chair.

KEY TERMS

1. Linguistics

“The study of human speech including the units, nature, structure, and modification of language”
(Merriam-Webster.com)

2. Coloniality of Language

Anibal Quijano’s concept of coloniality of power* (“foundational power structures of the modern world system that persist today”) in terms of linguistic dynamics established during colonization that impact language in post-colonial societies today.

* Quijano’s concept is derived from Latin American history but can be expanded to explain the linguistic histories of any colonized group/region.

3. Linguistic Colonization

Linguistic colonization refers to the direct action of enforcing linguistic assimilation/adoption of European language upon colonized peoples.

4. Linguistic Restrictionism

Policies, movements, and ideologies aimed at enforcing linguistic homogeneity in a given society. This is often used in the context of minority/immigrant languages in preference of a dominant language.

5. Heritage Language

A minority language spoken in the society of a different dominant language; often spoken at home or within a community reflects the cultural identity of speakers.

6. Intergenerational Transmission

The act of passing a language on to children and the following generations.

7. Three- Generation Rule

The theory that a heritage language in immigrant families is lost by the third generation in favor of the dominant language.

1. First generation speaker: Referring to the immigrants who have strong proficiency in their native tongue.
2. Second generation speaker: Bilingual children of immigrants, who exclusively use heritage language at home for communication with first generation, but use dominant language in public settings
3. Third generation speaker: Grandchildren of immigrants, children of second generation who are often monolingual speakers of the dominant language with little to no proficiency in heritage language

8. Globalization

“The development of an increasingly integrated global economy marked especially by free trade, free flow of capital, and the tapping of cheaper foreign labor markets” (Merriam-Webster.com).

9. Language Revitalization

Community- driven efforts to restore the vitality of an endangered language for the purpose of strengthening cultural identity, social cohesion, and reversing effects of historical oppression. Revitalization is different from language "revival" which refers to revisiting dead languages with no native speakers, and often lacks cultural connection (e.g., Latin), unlike revitalization efforts often growing from within a cultural community, and often having at least a few elderly speakers remaining.

10. Official Language

Official Language is a language that has been designated a legal right to be used in government and legalities.

11. National Language

National Language is a language that has state-wide recognition as a representation of identity for citizens. A national language is meant to strengthen linguistic unity among citizens.

12. Subtractive Bilingualism

The loss of proficiency in a native language due to learning a dominant secondary language in its favored sphere.

13. Language Status

The relative public opinion of a language and/or dialect. Language status can vary from perspective, but it is most commonly used in the context of linguistic discrimination.

14. Principle of Linguistic Subordination

A form of prejudice that evaluates certain language varieties and dialects as inferior and/or “incorrect” to the dominant variety/dialect by methods of speaking, grammar syntax, etc.; oftentimes a result of historical discrimination towards speakers of a certain variety/dialect.

Historical Background

Ethnographers estimate the presence of over 7,000 languages in the world, 40% of those estimated to be endangered by UNESCO. Today, the most pressing issue for language conservation is globalization. Languages with economic power in a certain region, often meaning governmental official languages, in which business affairs are conducted, result in dominance of said language due to demand for communication. Therefore, in a globalized world, socioeconomic, political, and cultural factors are the determinants for language survival and endangerment (Campbell & Muntzel, 1989). Speakers of minority languages may see dominant languages as more appealing for job prospects, conducting civil affairs, or legalities. However, in the context of historical initiatives (systemic erasure, imperialism, etc.), a huge factor behind interrupting inter-generational transmission of heritage languages emerges from fear of discrimination. During times of erasure initiatives, including colonialism, state-sponsored homogeneity initiatives, and systemic discrimination, harmful rhetoric towards speakers of heritage languages develops, and therefore generates negative public opinions of speakers, discouraging the use of and passing on the language (Fernando et al., 2010).

We will examine different eras of concentration that contextualize different types of linguistic erasure; colonial, post-colonial, and globalization.

COLONIAL ERA (17TH CENTURY ~ MID-19TH CENTURY*)

*Delegates should keep in mind that the time period of what is considered the “colonial era” will differ from region to region, and should approach this portion of research in context of their allocation.

As a broad concept, the colonial era of world history is defined as the early 17th century to the mid-19th century. As delegates will explore in their allocations, there are many caveats to this timeline, as it can be defined differently for each geopolitical region. For the purpose of this

committee, we will refer to the colonial era as the period when European colonialism began to consume nearly every continent all up until post-WWII (1940-1960s), when a large portion of colonized countries were granted independence from European powers (Breña, 2018). Delegates will further explore the timelines of colonial influences of their allocated country in research, as each country has their own unique history.

During this time period, Western European powers enforced linguistic imperialism in many of their colonies, forcing the language on Indigenous peoples, resulting in distance from culture and linguistic assimilation (Ghosh, 2025). European colonization established many power structures, including racial hierarchies that attempted to legitimize colonization. This expanded upon linguistic assimilation, as speaking Indigenous languages was often discouraged and/or identified speakers as targets of discrimination. This is why the attitude towards speakers that contributes to the loss of generational transmission can oftentimes be traced back to the colonial era, hence why it is relevant for the premise of this committee (Grenoble & Whaley, 2006).

POST- COLONIAL ERA (1945-1991)

The post-colonial period is marked by the beginning and end of the Cold War, as new independent nations took on the challenge of building an identity away from colonial influence while also navigating where to align themselves in the ideological battle between the United States and the Soviet Union. This is an important period in linguistics history because it focuses on both linguistic debates in post-colonial nations as well as Soviet imperialism and Russification of Soviet territories (Dostal & Knippenberg, 1992). For the purpose of this committee, we will separate the *Post-Colonial Era* from *Globalization* with the end of WWII to the fall of the Soviet Union, as these events defined policy across the world.

The nuances of Soviet Russification are held in how large and diverse those residing in Soviet territories are culturally and linguistically. In 2020, the modern borders of Russia were estimated to contain 125-150 minority languages spoken within its borders, with 62 being classified as critically endangered (Jankiewicz et al., 2020). The Soviet Union spread the Russian language from Eastern Europe to Asia, and has created a unique linguistic history for each post-Soviet country.

After independence, many countries looked to redefine their national identity away from colonization. This was seen most commonly in Africa, such in Tanzania, where new leaders pushed back against colonial languages such as English. President Nyerere of Tanzania pushed for Swahili as the official mode of communication, at the time, the only other African country besides Ethiopia (Amharic) to declare this (Mugane, 2002).

The Post-Colonial Era was experienced differently for every nation, as the world experienced many political shifts that catalyzed internal linguistic initiatives.

GLOBALIZATION (1991-PRESENT)

The fall of the Soviet Union left many post- Soviet nations with a convoluted linguistic identity- many wanted to revert to heritage languages and foster revitalization efforts; however, this was challenged by the growth of globalization that favored dominant languages such as Russian. Communication is being redefined by technology that creates instantaneous messages. As business and commerce become increasingly intertwined and facilitated by modern technology, economic concerns make dominant languages valuable. As large global powers such as the United States, China, and historically the UK and Russia have disproportionately influenced global trade, large- scale technological development, and therefore, linguistic hierarchies in the economic and scientific spheres. Globalization tends to reflect existing power structures; with modern globalization, we are seeing the linguistic and cultural influence of dominant nations spread across the world alongside economic, technological, and political influence (Phillipson, 1992).

Anglophone globalization is the result of the United Kingdom's colonial expansion, and has been carried on by the United States, Canada, and other post-colonial nations that have received the English language as a result. The United States, however, has furthered this globalization of English by dominating technological and military spheres. The influence of English overseas since the Cold War is mostly a result of American militarization (Crystal, 2003). In the 21st century, English has further expanded with technology and increasingly intertwined global activity, referring to the growth of social media. de Swann (2001) described

global languages as a hierarchical system, and English being placed in a “hypercentral” position that is a result of these past actions. With technological growth being mainly developed in the United States, and/or developed by American citizens, the English language becomes standard in the genesis of many social platforms; such as Facebook, founded in 2004, cited as the beginning of globalized social media.

Past UN Involvement

UNESCO has long been dedicated to language preservation. Dating back to 1953, with UNESCO’s *The Use of Vernacular Languages in Education*, the organization has been resolute in advocating to improve learning outcomes and preserve linguistic and cultural diversity in the educational system through Multilingual Education. This stance was further reinforced in the UNESCO General Conference in 1999, where UNESCO urged Member States to promote multilingual education, and in 2003 where *Education in a Multilingual World* acknowledged multilingualism as a global reality, and that the inevitability of multilingualism should be channeled into opportunities for education (UNESCO 2025).

UNESCO has also been mobilizing efforts in transforming education policies and practices to support Multilingual Education (MLE) guidance for young learners. On International Mother Language Day, UNESCO reports demonstrate the positive impact of integrating multilingualism in primary education systems for children to learn in their mother tongue (UNESCO 2025). MLE guidelines focus primarily on directing educational policymakers and key educational stakeholders at national and subnational levels, in addition to the entire education community, that includes teachers, school administrators, and educators of all levels. The guidance according to UNESCO supports the integration of languages spoken by Indigenous peoples, ethnic minority groups, migrants, and refugees, and is in reference to UNESCO’s *Education in a Multilingual World* position paper in 2003. Steps policymakers and implementers can take in accordance with UNESCO’s guidance initiate practical actions regarding laws and policies, curriculum, teacher recruitment, educational facilities and learning spaces, monitoring and evaluation, and developing partnerships with key stakeholders (UNESCO 2025).

To spread awareness of the challenges Indigenous Peoples and their important role in preserving their native languages, culture, and knowledge, the UN established the Global Action Plan of the International Decade of Indigenous Languages in 2019. The Decade, ranging from 2022 - 2032, will be led by UNESCO, in which the agency makes a global call to “preserve, revitalize and promote Indigenous languages while mainstreaming linguistic diversity and multilingualism into sustainable development efforts,” (UNESCO 2024). This decade of appreciation aims to not only bring awareness to the endangered nature of indigenous languages, but also is a decade to mobilize stakeholders to participate in a global action plan that looks to equip indigenous languages across sociocultural, economic, environmental, legal, and political domains. Ten interlinked themes are considered in the Global Action Plan: (1) Education that is qualitative and inclusive in Indigenous languages, (2) application of Indigenous Peoples’ languages and knowledge to ending hunger, (3) Digital empowerment and the right of expression in Indigenous languages, (4) health in Indigenous language framework, (5) public services in indigenous languages, (6) Heritage and all forms of culture for Indigenous peoples, (7) Indigenous languages’ contribution to the protection of biodiversity, (8) Economic and growth and job opportunities for Indigenous peoples, (9) using the preservation, revitalization, and promotion of Indigenous languages to promote gender equality and women’s empowerment, (10) long-term public-private partnerships towards the preservation of indigenous languages (UNESCO 2024).

In reference to UNESCO’s efforts to achieve Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), MLE not only directly supports specific goals related to education, but also creates opportunities to foster other SDGs. The goal to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” (SDG 4) is directly supported by MLE efforts to integrate children’s mother tongue in education and instruction, opening up opportunities and breaking down barriers to literacy and academic success (UNESCO 2025). Simultaneously, MLE presents chances to foster sustainable economic development (SDG 8), reduce inequalities (SDG 10), combat climate change (SDG 13), protect aquatic and land ecosystems (SDG 14-15), and promote peaceful, inclusive societies (SDG 16) (UNESCO n.d).

Case Studies

CASE STUDY #1- MARIE WILCOX AND WUKCHUMNI

The Wukchumni dialect is a language variety of the Tule-Kaweah language, originating in the central valley of California from the Yokutsan family, is a language that was on the verge of death. In the late 1990s, Marie Wilcox (1933-2021) began documenting Wukchumni, as she realized she was the last native speaker. For the next 20 years, Wilcox worked to put together a dictionary of Wukchumni, in hopes the language could be revitalized. In 2014, journalist and filmmaker Emmanuel Vaughan-Lee documented her efforts in a short film called “Marie’s Dictionary,” bringing attention to her work. Her Wukchumni dictionary included written entries, audio recordings to record pronunciations, expressions, phrases, cultural background, and word descriptions. She started by writing from her memory, and over the years, her family had helped her navigate a computer to organize her work. Typing with only her pointer fingers, Marie produced one of the most comprehensive written records ever created for Wukchumni. This was revolutionary, as many Indigenous languages (Wukchumni included) are traditionally only transmitted orally without written recordings (Sun Gazette, 2021).

After the documentary film was released, it drew many eyes to Marie’s work in her small town. Many journalism outlets began interviewing her and her family members to learn about her process. While the language is still critically endangered, this symbolizes revitalization efforts that are successful at starting a new life for dying languages.

She expanded her efforts in the community, teaming up with her daughter to lead language classes as the local Owens Valley Career Development Center, and encouraged other tribal members, especially the youth, to take initiative to utilize Marie’s efforts to learn Wukchumni (Global Oneness Project, n.d.; Good.is, 2015). These teaching efforts helped bring her dictionary from a document to a living resource for the community. By 2021, many members of Wilcox’s family and others had become at least three fluent speakers of Wukchumni, and her great-great-grandson was being raised with the language from birth (New York Times, 2021).

Marie passed away on September 25, 2021, in her hometown of Visalia, CA. Her efforts have saved the vitality of the Wukchumni language; and even in the case that there were no new learners/speakers, the documentation she accomplished has cemented the Wukchumni language in history, and ensured it cannot be forgotten to history. This demonstrates a successful revitalization attempt of a dying language, and therefore cultural preservation.

CASE STUDY #2- SOVIET RUSSIFICATION

In the Soviet Union (1922-1991), linguistic homogenization initiatives were central features of nationality policy that attempted to erase the vast diversity that encompassed the territory in the name of “building identity”; however, was weaponized as a tool in executing past prejudices, and building new ones. Soviet Russification, as the process is named, began in the 1930s, as early Bolsheviks promoted policies of “korenizatsiya” (indigenization), that were aimed at developing non-Russian languages for local elites, but under Stalin had advanced to enforcing Russian as the lingua franca of the USSR (Martin, 2001). This new emphasis on the Russian language was justified as an act of ‘unification’ or something ‘necessary’ for the prosperity of the state. While this may be true, the diminishing of smaller, local languages in favor of Russian was also used as a tool to reinforce the political and cultural dominance and influence of the USSR over ethnically non-Russians in its borders (Smith, 1998).

Under Stalin, Soviet leadership associated centralized control of citizens with linguistic unity, beginning mandates for Russian communication. In 1938, Russian language was required for instruction in schools across the USSR. This marked a new era of linguistic policies in the territory, as it drastically contrasted 1920s policies. It mirrored Tsarist Russification, reawakening discriminatory stereotypes and notions surrounding non-Russian languages from pre-Bolshevik times (Grenoble, 2003). Russian was promoted as the language of science, administration, and education, and many heritage languages faced erosion over the next couple decades.

After World War II (1945), Russification became more intense, mostly seen in the Baltic states, Ukraine, and Central Asia. Soviet territories allowed for large-scale migration of Russian-speaking populations across non-Russian republics, which altered demographic balances and influenced perspectives on speakers of non-Russian languages, as well as enforcing Russian as a lingua franca with further growth of the use of Russian in urban centers (Smith, 1998). Through educational enforcement, technical fields became restricted to Russian speakers, reinforcing the power of the language even in a communist state. Russia was associated with education, modernity, economic advancement, and especially, eurocentrism (Blistein, 2001). Local languages were put in jeopardy by Russification initiatives systemically minimizing their utility in public life, revealing why ~148 languages within Russia are noted as (at least) endangered (UNESCO).

The effects of Russification are still present today, as many people of post-Soviet nations speak Russian as a second language. The cultural imperialism done by these initiatives, as bilingualism was widespread, but often used as a discriminatory tool towards non-Russian speaking groups. Speakers of a given heritage language were expected to learn Russian and continue to face prejudices today in their own communities. This is why inter-generational transmission of heritage languages is interrupted; this example provides both a systemic and discriminatory reason for said interruption. With growing globalization, history is not repeating, but rather expanding upon itself. Russian as a common language between millions of people allows for business affairs and economic incentives. Globalization means that revitalization efforts for heritage languages can be difficult, as it lacks incentives for (primarily) the youth to learn.

CASE STUDY #3- INDIGENOUS BOARDING SCHOOLS

From the late 19th century onward, federal and church-run boarding schools systematically removed Indigenous children from their communities with the goal of pure, Eurocentric assimilation into American/Canadian society. Seen in both the United States and Canada, a manifestation of heavy discrimination and violence towards Indigenous people since the colonization of the Americas, these schools were an example of cultural erasure through language. A central mechanism of these schools was the prohibition of native languages, and the

mandate of English. The use of heritage languages would result in corporal punishment, coercing the speaking of the English language and the abandonment of native languages (Language Loss, 2019). The violence practiced in these schools with the enforcement of linguistic homogeny constitutes a form of cultural genocide through linguisticide, argue scholars (IndigenousNetwork.org, 2022; American Academy of Arts and Sciences, 2025).

Within these schools, children were forbidden from speaking their languages, and the use of English (or even French, in French-speaking Canadian territories) was enforced by not only physical punishment, but also in cruel forms of isolation and humiliation (Facing History & Ourselves, 2019; Courthouse News Service, 2025). These policies were a systemic example of linguistic erasure, and stemmed from colonial ideologies that equated traits of Indigenous cultures with “savagery” and European languages with “civilization”, demonstrating the prejudiced ideas that Indigenous culture and identity had to be erased for “advancement” (Broberg, 2025).

Today, scholars and Indigenous advocates highlight the link between language and identity, demonstrating how language loss was not just a result of these schools, but a key strategy of forced assimilation (IndigenousNetwork.org, 2022)

Questions to Consider

- 1) In this topic, we must focus on how history has impacted the linguistic state of the world today, and how globalization has impacted preexisting structures.
 - 2) How does globalization exacerbate the effects of systemic erasure initiatives, especially for speakers of heritage languages and their ethnic communities?
 - 3) How are revitalization efforts around the world impacting language for the future? What methods of revitalization have shown to be successful or unsuccessful?
 - 4) How do the attitudes of the youth impact the survival of a language?
 - 5) How has 21st Century immigration impacted the language around the world? What are the ethics of non-dominant language transmission in a dominant language's society?
 - 6) Can globalization exacerbate preexisting prejudices surrounding heritage languages and their speakers?
 - 7) What is the role of media production in language revitalization?
 - 8) Are there enough incentives for language revitalization among youth?
 - 9) How have historical backgrounds contributed to the impact of globalization on language?
-

Closing Remarks

Overall, today's status of global languages is a reflection of history. Throughout the eras of colonization, post-colonial nation building, and what this committee aims to consider, globalization, language has been ever-changing. The effects of colonization have left nations with identity/linguistic crises, many of which have been expanded upon in the post-colonial era. In globalization, language conservation looks different. We can't break global interconnectivity, however, we must notice that globalization can exacerbate pressures on heritage languages, many of which have been under pressure since the colonial era. In this new era of technological and economic advancements, it is important for us to consider how language can be preserved, and therefore, how culture can be protected. Delegates should examine revitalization efforts, such as Marie Wilcox, and study the successes and failures of methods taken. In studying revitalization techniques, it is important delegates acknowledge the historical contexts of the status of many endangered languages, because we must understand their background to preserve them. Every nation on Earth has its own unique linguistic history, which is why delegates are encouraged to study the background of their delegation's history, as well as surrounding countries. For this committee, we want delegates to ask themselves, how can language and culture be preserved successfully, given the history of language, and current challenges posed by globalization.

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